

RUCompliant

Compliance That Has Your Back

Product Requirements Document

Microbusiness Edition — UK Market

Target Market	Microbusinesses: sub-10 employees, sub-£2m revenue — UK
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1. Executive Summary

RUCompliant is a compliance-as-a-service platform built for the 5.4 million microbusinesses in the UK — businesses with fewer than 10 employees and under £2 million in annual revenue. These businesses face the same legal obligations as large enterprises but have none of the resources, expertise, or budget to meet them. RUCompliant changes that.

1.1 The Problem

Approximately 78% of employing microbusinesses in the UK have between 1 and 4 employees. These are sole traders, husband-and-wife operations, freelancers with a small team — people who are expert at what they do but have no compliance knowledge whatsoever. They are not non-compliant by choice. Nobody told them.

The Core Insight

Most microbusiness owners are non-compliant not because they don't care, but because nobody has ever walked them through what they actually need to do. RUCompliant does exactly that — proactively, affordably, and in plain English.

1.2 The Solution

RUCompliant is a compliance concierge. Not a generic dashboard. Not a scaled-down Vanta. A service that has your back. It knows what obligations apply to your specific business, tells you when action is needed, holds your hand through every step, and remembers everything so you don't have to.

Three features sit at the heart of the product:

- The Compliance Health Score — a single, always-visible indicator showing whether the business is Green (all clear), Amber (attention needed) or Red (urgent action required).
- The Compliance Task Calendar — a personalised, rolling calendar of every deadline, filing, review, and renewal relevant to this specific business.
- The Concierge Onboarding Journey — a guided, phased walkthrough that takes a brand-new business through every formation and setup obligation in the right order, at the right time.

1.3 Market Opportunity

Segment	UK Count	RUCompliant Focus
Non-employing (sole traders, owner-only)	4.1 million	Concierge journey + calendar
1–4 employees	~900,000	Full platform, headcount triggers
5–9 employees	~255,000	All modules + H&S threshold alerts
10–49 employees (small)	~220,000	Out of scope for MVP

2. User Personas

RUCompliant is designed for non-technical users. Every design decision — copy, layout, flow, error messages — must be tested against these three personas before shipping. If persona 1 (Sarah) cannot complete a task without help, it is not ready.

Why Personas Matter

A vague user definition ('microbusiness owner') leads to vague design decisions. These three personas represent the real range of RUCompliant's target market. Persona 1 is the primary design target for MVP.

Persona 1 — Sarah, the Sole Trader (Primary MVP Target)

Attribute	Detail
Name & Age	Sarah, 52
Business	Sole trader — mobile dog grooming, operating for 3 years
Employees	None (occasionally uses her daughter as holiday cover)
Tech Confidence	Low. Uses WhatsApp, Facebook, and online banking. Has never used a SaaS tool.
Device	iPhone as primary device. Occasionally uses a laptop for banking.
Compliance Status	Registered as self-employed with HMRC but has never registered with the ICO, has no written privacy policy, and does not know what a Confirmation Statement is.
Primary Anxiety	"I don't want to get in trouble. I just don't know what I'm supposed to be doing."
Design Implication	Every screen must be completable without reading more than 3 sentences. No technical terms without inline explanation. Must feel like a person is guiding her, not a system.

Persona 2 — James, the Ltd Company Founder

Attribute	Detail
Name & Age	James, 34
Business	Limited company — digital design agency, trading 2 years
Employees	3 full-time employees + 1 part-time. About to hire a 5th.
Tech Confidence	Medium-high. Uses Notion, Slack, Xero. Comfortable with SaaS tools but stretched thin.
Device	MacBook as primary. iPhone secondary.

Attribute	Detail
Compliance Status	Uses an accountant for annual accounts and VAT. Thinks he is "probably compliant" but hasn't thought about H&S, written employment contracts, or right to work checks.
Primary Anxiety	"I know I have gaps. I just don't have time to find and fix them all."
Design Implication	Appreciates efficiency. Wants to see his specific gaps, not generic guidance. The dashboard must show him exactly what he needs to do next and nothing else.

Persona 3 — Tom & Linda, the Couple-Run Business

Attribute	Detail
Name & Age	Tom (58) and Linda (55)
Business	Limited company — B&B with a café, trading 8 years
Employees	2 part-time employees. Seasonal patterns.
Tech Confidence	Low-medium. Linda manages bookings online; Tom handles the property. Neither uses business software.
Device	Mix of iPad (Linda) and Android phone (Tom). Rarely use a desktop.
Compliance Status	Have a fire risk assessment from 5 years ago. No written employment contracts. No ICO registration. No GDPR privacy policy despite collecting customer data.
Primary Anxiety	"We've been doing this for years and nothing bad has happened. But we're worried we're sitting on problems we don't know about."
Design Implication	Multi-user access matters. Both need to see the same compliance picture. Mobile-first is critical for this persona. The product must reassure as well as inform.

Multi-User Access — MVP Decision

For MVP, RUCompliant supports one user account per business.

Tom & Linda can share login credentials — this is an acceptable MVP compromise.

Multi-user access (separate logins, same business) is a SHOULD HAVE for Phase 3.

This decision must be documented in onboarding so couples/partners are not confused.

3. MVP Feature Prioritisation (MoSCoW)

This section is the most operationally important in the document. It defines what RUCompliant must ship to call MVP 'done', what should be included if capacity allows, what could be added post-launch, and what is deliberately out of scope for now.

Definition of MVP

The minimum set of features that allows a non-technical sole trader (Persona 1 — Sarah) to sign up, complete the Concierge Journey, understand her compliance status, receive deadline reminders, and ask a question to the AI Advisor — all without any human support from RUCompliant.

3.1 MUST HAVE — Cannot ship MVP without these

If any MUST HAVE feature is missing or broken, the product should not launch.

Priority	Feature / Requirement	User Benefit	Acceptance Criteria (brief)
MUST	Guided sign-up flow (5 questions max) that establishes business type, headcount, VAT status, and sector	Sarah can start in under 3 minutes without confusion	<i>Given a new user signs up, they see ≤5 questions. Progress bar is visible. They can skip non-mandatory questions. On completion, dashboard populates immediately.</i>
MUST	Compliance Health Score dashboard — RAG status, 6 domain breakdown, next 3 actions	Immediate clarity: "Am I OK?" answered in 10 seconds	<i>Health Score is the first element above the fold on every login. Colour-coded. Each domain shows a sub-status. The next 3 overdue/upcoming tasks are visible without scrolling.</i>
MUST	Concierge Journey — Stages 1–3 (Register & Exist, Operate Safely, Build Good Habits)	Non-technical user guided through setup without needing an accountant	<i>Each stage has ≤8 tasks. Each task has a plain-English title, a 2-sentence explanation, and a "Mark as done" or guided action. Progress saves automatically.</i>

Priority	Feature / Requirement	User Benefit	Acceptance Criteria (brief)
			<i>Incomplete journey shows on dashboard.</i>
MUST	Task Calendar — auto-populated with statutory deadlines from business profile	User never misses a filing deadline because they didn't know it existed	<i>Given a VAT-registered Ltd company user, the calendar must auto-populate with: quarterly VAT return dates, annual accounts date, Confirmation Statement date, and Corporation Tax return date. All dates are correct for their specific accounting period.</i>
MUST	Escalating email reminders (30 days / 14 days / 7 days / 3 days / overdue)	User is warned before deadlines, not just when they miss them	<i>Test: VAT return created for 30 days time triggers email at 30 days. Email subject line includes RAG status. Email links directly to the relevant task in the app.</i>
MUST	AI Advisor flyout — contextual, RAG-powered, with plain-English responses	User can ask any compliance question and get a relevant, personalised answer	<i>Advisor opens within 200ms of button click. Responses reference the user's actual business profile. Each response includes a confidence indicator. Response time under 8 seconds. Advisor never navigates user away from current page.</i>
MUST	Confidence indicator on every AI Advisor response (Green / Amber / Red dot)	Non-technical user knows when to trust the answer vs. seek professional help	<i>Every AI response shows a coloured dot. Green = high confidence. Amber includes text: "You may want to confirm this with your accountant." Red</i>

Priority	Feature / Requirement	User Benefit	Acceptance Criteria (brief)
MUST			includes text: "This situation is complex — I recommend speaking to a professional."
	Document Vault — upload, categorise, and store documents with expiry tracking	User has one place for all compliance evidence	User can upload PDF, JPG, PNG. Files are auto-categorised (with user able to override). Expiry date can be set. Documents viewable within the app. Max file size: 25MB.
MUST	Empty state experience — every screen has a clear, guided empty state before any data exists	First-time user is never confronted with a blank screen	On first login, dashboard shows a "Welcome" state with a single CTA: "Start your compliance journey." Calendar empty state shows what will populate after setup. Every module has an empty state with a description and next action.
MUST	Help pathway — in-app access to documentation and support contact	Non-technical user has a clear route when stuck	A "Help" link is visible on every page (minimum: in the sidebar nav). Clicking opens a panel with: searchable FAQ, 3 most relevant articles based on current page, and a "Contact support" button (email-based for MVP).
MUST	Stripe billing — monthly and annual plans, 14-day free trial, no credit card at signup	Low-friction conversion from trial to paid	User can sign up with email only. Trial starts immediately. At Day 14, a payment prompt appears. Annual plan pre-selected. No forced card

Priority	Feature / Requirement	User Benefit	Acceptance Criteria (brief)
			<i>entry before Day 14.</i>
MUST	Plain English throughout — no jargon without inline explanation	Non-technical user understands every label, instruction, and error message	<i>Any term that appears in the top-50 confusing compliance terms list (Appendix A) must include a tooltip or inline definition. All UI copy must pass a Flesch-Kincaid reading ease score of 60+ (equivalent to plain English for a general adult audience).</i>

3.2 SHOULD HAVE — Include if MVP timeline allows

These features significantly improve the product but are not blockers to initial launch.

Priority	Feature / Requirement	User Benefit	Acceptance Criteria (brief)
SHOULD	SMS notifications for Red-tier alerts	Urgent matters reach users who don't check email	<i>Red-tier tasks trigger SMS within 1 hour of becoming Red. User can opt out in notification preferences.</i>
SHOULD	Push notifications (web push, not native app)	Timely prompts without requiring email open	<i>Users can enable push notifications in browser. Notifications sent for 7-day and 3-day deadline warnings.</i>
SHOULD	Google Calendar and Outlook sync (read: push RUCompliant deadlines to external calendar)	Compliance deadlines appear alongside other business appointments	<i>User can connect Google or Outlook account in Settings. RUCompliant deadlines appear as calendar events. Sync is one-way (RUCompliant → calendar) for MVP.</i>

Priority	Feature / Requirement	User Benefit	Acceptance Criteria (brief)
SHOULD	ICO Registration guidance and reminder workflow	Most microbusinesses need ICO registration and don't know it	<i>Concierge Journey Stage 1 includes ICO registration. Advisor can answer ICO questions with high confidence. Renewal reminder set to 60 days before expiry.</i>
SHOULD	HR Hub — pre-hire checklist and employment contract generator (first hire trigger)	Eliminates the most dangerous compliance gap at the moment of first hire	<i>When user updates headcount from 0 to 1, HR Hub activates automatically. Pre-hire checklist appears in calendar. Contract generator produces a compliant written statement via a guided Q&A of ≤10 questions.</i>
SHOULD	Concierge Journey Stage 4 — Ready to Grow (employment readiness)	Prepares businesses for their first hire before it happens	<i>Stage 4 unlocks after Stage 3 is Green. Includes: right to work check guidance, auto-enrolment awareness, H&S baseline.</i>
SHOULD	Headcount trigger logic — automatic task activation when employee count changes	User never has to know that hiring triggers compliance obligations	<i>When user updates headcount from 4 to 5 in settings, H&S policy and formal risk assessment tasks are automatically added to calendar. User receives an in-app notification explaining what has changed and why.</i>
SHOULD	Accountant share — read-only calendar and task link	User can collaborate with their existing accountant	<i>User can generate a shareable link in Settings. Link gives read-only</i>

Priority	Feature / Requirement	User Benefit	Acceptance Criteria (brief)
SHOULD		without sharing login credentials	access to task calendar and Health Score. Link can be revoked. No account creation required for the accountant.
	Mobile camera upload in Document Vault (OCR + auto-categorise)	User can photograph paper documents on mobile	User can take a photo using mobile browser. OCR extracts text. System suggests category. User confirms or overrides. Document stored in correct vault section.
	Monthly digest email — Health Score trend + upcoming deadlines	Regular touchpoint that brings users back to the app	Sent on the 1st of each month to all active users. Shows Health Score trend (was Green/Amber/Red last month, now X). Lists upcoming deadlines in the next 30 days. One-click link to each task.
SHOULD	Regulatory news feed — plain-English summaries of changes relevant to this business	User is informed of regulatory changes without having to monitor GOV.UK themselves	Feed shows ≤5 items. Each item is a 1-sentence summary with a "Read more" link. Items are filtered to only show changes relevant to the user's sector, headcount, and VAT status.

3.3 COULD HAVE — Post-MVP backlog

Priority	Feature / Requirement	User Benefit	Acceptance Criteria (brief)	
COULD	Health & Safety module — risk assessment builder, H&S policy generator, DSE assessment	Covers obligations that apply from the first employee	Full H&S module with headcount-aware obligation map. H&S policy generator activates at 5th employee.	
COULD	GDPR tiering — Tier 2 and Tier 3 obligations (beyond basic ICO registration)	Serves businesses with more complex data obligations	GDPR questions in Concierge Journey map to Tier 1/2/3. Additional obligations surface automatically based on tier.	
COULD	Evidence pack export — formatted, indexed PDF for auditors or insurers	Business can demonstrate compliance to a third party instantly	One-click export from Document Vault. Generates a PDF with a cover page, table of contents, and all stored documents indexed by category.	
COULD	Auto-enrolment tracker — per-employee eligibility and staging date tracking	Employer never misses auto-enrolment obligations	Accessible from HR Hub. Per-employee eligibility check (age 22+, earnings £10k+). Letter templates for eligible employees.	
COULD	Gamification — compliance streak counter, Green Day badge	Rewards consistent compliance behaviour and increases retention	Streak shown on dashboard. Badge for first 30 consecutive Green days. Not shown to users who are currently Red.	
COULD	AI Advisor voice input (Whisper API)	Users who prefer speaking to typing can interact naturally	Microphone icon in Advisor input bar. Voice converted to text. Standard Advisor response flow.	
COULD	Advisor conversation export as PDF	User can share Advisor conversations with	Export button on any conversation thread. Generates	

Priority	Feature / Requirement	User Benefit	Acceptance Criteria (brief)	
COULD		accountant or solicitor	<i>formatted PDF with RUCompliant branding, date, and conversation content.</i>	
	Compliance Health Score website widget (embeddable)	Business can display their compliance status to customers and clients	<i>User generates an embed code in Settings. Widget shows current RAG status. Auto-updates. Mobile-responsive.</i>	
COULD	White-label option for accountants and bookkeepers	Accountants can resell RUCompliant under their own brand	<i>Separate partner onboarding flow. Custom logo and colour scheme. Accountant manages multiple client businesses from a single dashboard.</i>	

3.4 WON'T HAVE — Explicitly out of scope for MVP

Priority	Feature / Requirement	User Benefit	Acceptance Criteria (brief)	
WON'T	Native iOS or Android app	Web app with responsive design is sufficient for MVP	<i>Post-MVP evaluation in Phase 4.</i>	
WON'T	Multi-user access (separate logins per business)	Single shared login is acceptable for MVP	<i>SHOULD HAVE for Phase 3.</i>	
WON'T	Direct HMRC or Companies House API integration (auto-filing)	Regulatory and liability complexity is too high for MVP	<i>Long-term roadmap. Requires FCA/HMRC partner agreements.</i>	
WON'T	In-app payment for compliance services (e.g. book a solicitor)	Marketplace model is a separate product decision	<i>Could Have for Phase 4.</i>	

Priority	Feature / Requirement	User Benefit	Acceptance Criteria (brief)	
WON'T	Multi-currency or non-UK compliance obligations	UK market focus is the entire basis of the product's value proposition	<i>Not in roadmap.</i>	
WON'T	Real-time collaboration (multiple users editing simultaneously)	Beyond the technical complexity appropriate for MVP	<i>Not in near-term roadmap.</i>	

4. First-Time User Experience (FTUE)

The first-time user experience is the highest-stakes moment in the product. A non-technical user who is confused or underwhelmed in the first five minutes will not return. This section defines exactly what a new user sees, hears, and does from the moment they land on the sign-up page to the moment they see their first populated dashboard.

Design Principle — FTUE

Every step of the FTUE must be completable by Persona 1 (Sarah, the sole trader, low tech confidence, mobile phone) in under 8 minutes. If any step requires more than 3 items of information or more than 15 seconds of reading, it must be redesigned.

4.1 Sign-Up Flow

Step	What the User Sees	What RUCompliant Does	Design Rules
1	Landing page CTA: "Get started — it's free for 14 days. No credit card needed." Single email input field and "Create my account" button.	Creates account record. Sends welcome email. Redirects to Step 2.	No password at signup — magic link sent to email. Removes friction for non-technical users.
2	Welcome screen: "Let's get your business set up. We'll ask you 5 quick questions — it takes about 2 minutes." Progress bar: Step 1 of 5.	Sets expectation. Reduces anxiety about a long form.	Large, friendly typography. Single question per screen (not a long form). Back button always visible.
3	Q1: "How is your business structured?" — 3 options as large tap targets: Sole trader / Self-employed Limited company Partnership	Maps to compliance obligation matrix. Determines which modules activate.	Options are images/icons + labels. No dropdowns. No typing required. Tooltip on each: "Not sure? Tap here."
4	Q2: "How many people work in your business (including you)?" — Large number selector: Just me 2–4 5–9 10+	Sets headcount tier. Determines H&S obligations.	"Including you" is critical — sole traders always count as 1. Plain-language labels, not numbers alone.
5	Q3: "Are you VAT registered?" — Yes No Not sure (+ "What's VAT registration? Tap to find out")	Determines if VAT calendar entries are needed.	"Not sure" is a valid answer — defaults to No with a note that this can be updated later.
6	Q4: "What type of business do you run?" — Searchable list with 12 common categories + "Other"	Maps to sector-specific obligations (H&S uplift, GDPR tier adjustment).	Categories use plain English: "Restaurant or café" not "Food service." Typing filters the list.
7	Q5: "When did your business start trading?" — Month/Year picker. Option: "We haven't started yet."	Sets the compliance timeline. Determines which deadlines are in the past vs. future.	Simple month/year picker. "We haven't started yet" is a valid option — activates pre-trading journey.

Step	What the User Sees	What RUCompliant Does	Design Rules
8	Completion screen: "You're all set, [first name]! We're building your compliance picture now..." — animated health score filling up.	Calculates initial health score from answers. Generates calendar entries. Activates Concierge Journey.	Animation should take 3–5 seconds (builds anticipation). Never show a blank dashboard.

4.2 The Welcome Dashboard — Empty State

The most common failure mode in SaaS products targeting non-technical users: they sign up, see a mostly empty screen, and leave. RUCompliant prevents this by ensuring the dashboard is never truly empty after setup.

Dashboard Element	Empty State Content (Before Tasks Completed)	Rule
Health Score	Shown as AMBER on first login with the message: "Your setup is in progress. Complete your Compliance Journey to reach Green." NOT shown as Red — Red is reserved for genuine legal risk.	Never show Green before the Concierge Journey is complete. Never show Red without a specific, actionable reason.
Next 3 Actions	Populated immediately from the Concierge Journey Stage 1 tasks. The dashboard is never empty — Sarah sees "Step 1: Register with HMRC" as her first action the moment she lands.	Always show 3 actions. If fewer than 3 tasks exist, show upcoming deadlines or Concierge Journey steps to fill the slots.
Domain Breakdown	All 6 domains shown in AMBER with a label: "Not yet assessed." Each has a single-tap CTA: "Set up now" which opens the relevant Concierge Journey stage.	Amber (not red) for unassessed domains. Red is only for confirmed legal risk.
Task Calendar	Shows auto-generated statutory deadlines immediately (e.g. Self Assessment due 31 Jan, Confirmation Statement due on anniversary). Label: "These deadlines were generated based on your business profile."	Calendar should never be empty. At minimum, auto-generate Self Assessment deadline for sole traders and Confirmation Statement for Ltd companies.
AI Advisor	Flyout shows 3 contextual starter questions: "What do I need to do first?", "What is a Confirmation Statement?", "Do I need to register with the ICO?" These are auto-selected based on business type.	Starter questions must be relevant to the user's specific business type — not generic. A sole trader should not see questions about Corporation Tax.

4.3 Concierge Journey — First Session Experience

After the setup questions, the user is directed to Stage 1 of the Concierge Journey. The experience must feel like being guided by a knowledgeable friend, not filling in a government form.

Stage 1 UX Principle

Each task in Stage 1 must have: a plain-English title (max 8 words), a 2-sentence explanation of why it matters, a clear action (external link to GOV.UK, or an in-app workflow), and a 'Mark as done' button.

The 'Mark as done' button is always visible. We trust the user. We do not gate progress behind proof.

If a task is marked done, it turns green and the next task animates into view. Progress feels immediate.

5. The Compliance Health Score

Design Principle — The Dashboard IS the Product

When a user opens RUCompliant, this is what they see first — every single time. It is the homepage. It answers the only question a microbusiness owner needs answered in 10 seconds: 'Am I OK right now?' Notifications bring the user to this dashboard. The dashboard is where they understand, decide, and act.

5.1 The Three-State Model

Status	What It Means	Triggers	User Experience	Notification Channel
 GREEN	All clear. No outstanding actions past their due date.	All tasks complete, no overdue items, no missed deadlines within the last 30 days.	Weekly digest only. No intrusive alerts. Dashboard shows green — user logs in, sees green, logs out confident.	Email (weekly digest)
 AMBER	Attention needed. Something is upcoming or slightly overdue.	Task due within 14 days, soft deadline missed, document nearing expiry, module not yet set up.	Email notification + in-app banner. Dashboard shows amber with the specific issue flagged.	Email
 RED	Urgent. Action required now. Risk of fine, penalty, or legal exposure.	Statutory deadline missed or within 3 days, legally mandatory task not completed, insurance lapsed.	Cannot be dismissed without action or explicit snooze. Dashboard leads with the red item.	Push + SMS + Email (daily until resolved)

5.2 Score Calculation — Six Compliance Domains

The overall score is determined by the worst single domain. If any domain is Red, the overall score is Red. This is intentional — a business cannot be 'mostly compliant.'

Domain	What It Covers	Key Red Triggers	Applies From
Formation & Registration	HMRC registration, Companies House filings, ICO registration	Overdue filing, missing registration	Day 1
Tax & Financial	VAT returns, payroll RTI, annual accounts, Self Assessment	Missed deadline, overdue payment	Day 1 (Self Assessment) / First employee (RTI)
Data Protection	ICO renewal, privacy policy, GDPR obligations by tier	Lapsed ICO, no privacy policy, breach unnotified	Day 1 (if collecting personal data)

Domain	What It Covers	Key Red Triggers	Applies From
Health & Safety	H&S policy, risk assessments, fire risk, DSE	Missing mandatory policy for headcount	1st employee
Employment & People	Contracts, right to work, auto-enrolment, NMW	Missing employment contract, pension duty missed	1st employee
Insurance	Employer's liability, public liability, professional indemnity	EL insurance lapsed or missing	1st employee (EL mandatory)

6. Notifications & Escalating Reminders

Notifications are the mechanism that brings users back to the dashboard. They are not the experience — they are the tap on the shoulder. Every notification links directly to the relevant task in the app.

Non-Technical User Principle

Notification copy must be written as if a helpful, knowledgeable friend is texting you — not as if a legal system is alerting you. 'Your VAT return is due in 7 days. Open RUCompliant to start — it takes about 15 minutes.' Not: 'Statutory deadline alert: VAT return submission required.'

6.1 Escalating Cadence

Days Until Deadline	Channel (MVP)	Channel (Full)	Tone	Example Message
30 days	Email	Email	Informational	"Heads up — your VAT return for Q3 is due in 30 days. No action needed yet."
14 days	Email	Email + In-app banner	Gentle prompt	"Your VAT return is due in 2 weeks. Here's what you'll need to have ready."
7 days	Email	Email + Push notification	Firmer	"Action needed: VAT return due in 7 days. Open RUCompliant to start your checklist."
3 days	Email	Email + Push + SMS	Urgent	"Urgent: Your VAT return is due in 3 days. It takes about 15 minutes — tap to start now."
Overdue	Email (daily)	All channels daily	Alert	"Your VAT return is now overdue. Late filing penalty: £200 + interest. Tap to file now."

6.2 Notification Preferences

Users can adjust notification preferences but cannot disable statutory deadline reminders entirely. This is a deliberate product decision — RUCompliant has their back even when they would rather not be reminded.

Setting	User Can Control?	Default	Notes
Email reminders — statutory deadlines	Frequency only (not off)	On — all cadence points	Cannot be fully disabled
Email reminders — compliance actions	On/Off + frequency	On	Can be disabled

Setting	User Can Control?	Default	Notes
Push notifications	On/Off	Off (user must opt in)	Browser permission required
SMS alerts	On/Off	Off (user must opt in)	Phone number required. Red-tier only.
Weekly digest email	On/Off	On	Can be disabled
Monthly digest email	On/Off	On	Can be disabled

7. Core Module Specifications

RUCompliant is structured around six core modules. In the MoSCoW framework: Modules 1, 2, and the AI Advisor (Module 6) are **MUST HAVEs** for MVP. Module 3 (HR Hub) and Document Vault (Module 5) are **SHOULD HAVEs**. Modules 4 (H&S) and full GDPR tiering are **COULD HAVEs**.

Module 1 — Compliance Hub & Health Score (MUST HAVE)

The always-on command centre. The first screen a user sees when they log in. Designed for a 10-second status check, not extended sessions. See Section 5 for full specification.

Feature	Description	MoSCoW	Acceptance Criteria
Health Score Display	Full-width RAG status — large, colour-coded, impossible to miss. Last-updated timestamp and trend vs last month.	MUST	Score visible above the fold on all viewport sizes. Colour contrast passes WCAG AA. Trend shown as arrow + label: "Up from Amber last month."
Domain Breakdown	Six compliance domains each with their own RAG status — expandable to see specific issues.	MUST	Domains listed with their current status. Clicking any domain expands to show specific issues. Red domains listed first.
Next 3 Actions	Three most urgent tasks from calendar, with one-tap access to the guided workflow.	MUST	Always shows exactly 3 items. If fewer than 3 overdue tasks, fills with upcoming deadlines. Tapping any item opens the relevant task.
Quick Stats	Days since last Red alert, compliance streak, documents in vault, next deadline date.	COULD	Stats update in real time. Streak resets if score goes Red.
Regulatory News Feed	Plain-English summaries of regulatory changes relevant to this business.	SHOULD	Shows ≤5 items. Filtered to user's sector and business type. Each item dated.

Module 2 — Compliance Task Calendar (MUST HAVE)

The operational heart of RUCompliant. The single source of truth for everything the business needs to do and when.

Design Principle — Personalised by Default

The calendar should feel like it was built specifically for this business — because it was. A sole trader sees a very different calendar to a business with 6 employees. Every item is relevant. Nothing is noise.

Task Type	Examples	Source	In-App Completion?	MoSCoW
Statutory Deadline	VAT return, Annual accounts, Confirmation Statement	Auto-populated from business profile	Partially — mark as filed, link to HMRC/Companies House	MUST
Compliance Action	Update privacy policy, Renew insurance, Complete risk assessment	Auto-populated from module status	Yes — guided workflow in-app	MUST
Trigger Event	New employee onboarding checklist, 5th employee H&S policy	User-triggered by headcount update	Yes — step-by-step checklist	SHOULD
Review & Renewal	ICO renewal, Pension re-enrolment, Annual policy review	Auto-scheduled from previous completion date	Yes — in-app with AI review	SHOULD

Module 3 — HR & Employment Hub (SHOULD HAVE)

Activated at first hire. Walks the business owner through every employment obligation in a guided, chronological sequence. The most dangerous compliance gaps for microbusinesses exist here.

Feature	Description	MoSCoW	Trigger
Pre-hire checklist	Right to work check reminder, contract preparation, payroll setup — all before Day 1.	SHOULD	User updates headcount from 0 to 1
Employment contract generator	Conversational Q&A generates a compliant written statement of employment terms for Day 1.	SHOULD	Manual — user initiates from HR Hub
Auto-enrolment tracker	Per-employee eligibility assessment (age 22+, earnings £10k+), staging date tracking, letter templates.	COULD	Headcount ≥1 eligible employee
Flexible working handler	Guides employer through statutory process — request logging, consideration period, response templates.	COULD	Manual — user initiates
HR document vault	Stores contracts, right to work evidence, DBS certificates with expiry tracking.	SHOULD	Always active within HR Hub
Headcount threshold alerts	Automatic alerts at 5 employees (H&S policy, formal risk recording).	SHOULD	Headcount update event
AI HR Advisor integration	Scenario-based Q&A — always surfaces creative/negotiated solutions before legal entitlements.	MUST	Always active (from Module 6)

Module 4 — Health & Safety (COULD HAVE — MVP)

Calibrated to the business's actual obligations based on headcount and sector. Never shows requirements that don't apply yet — but always shows what's coming next.

Feature	Description	MoSCoW	Headcount Trigger
H&S obligation map	Visual showing current obligations vs upcoming ones — updates dynamically.	COULD	Any
Risk assessment builder	Plain-English risk assessment template, auto-saved to vault, review date set automatically.	COULD	1st employee
H&S policy generator	Generates compliant written policy via short Q&A.	SHOULD	5th employee (legally required)
Fire risk assessment	Guided template for any premises with external resources for complex sites.	COULD	Any premises
DSE assessment	Simple self-assessment for each screen-based worker, results tracked and evidenced.	COULD	1st screen-based employee
RIDDOR guidance	Triggered if user logs a workplace accident — explains reporting obligations.	COULD	Any
Sector uplift	Higher-risk sectors (construction, hospitality, healthcare) receive additional prompts.	COULD	Set at onboarding

Module 5 — Document Vault (SHOULD HAVE)

The highest-retention feature in the product. Once a business stores documents here, RUCompliant becomes structurally embedded in how they operate.

Feature	Description	MoSCoW	Acceptance Criteria
Upload & categorise	Upload PDF, JPG, PNG. Auto-categorised into: Formation, Contracts, Policies, Insurance, Tax & Accounts, H&S, Training. User can override category.	MUST	Upload completes in ≤10 seconds for files under 10MB. Category suggestion shown. Override always available.
Expiry tracking	Insurance certificates, DBS certificates, licences — tracked with renewal reminders.	SHOULD	Expiry date field shown on upload. Reminder sent at 60 days before expiry.

Feature	Description	MoSCoW	Acceptance Criteria
Policy version control	Every policy version stored with date and update reason. Full audit trail.	SHOULD	Previous versions accessible. Current version clearly labelled.
AI document review	Upload existing documents for plain-English gap analysis.	COULD	Analysis returned within 30 seconds. Output is a plain-English summary of gaps.
Evidence pack export	One-click formatted, indexed PDF for auditors or insurers.	COULD	Export generated within 60 seconds. PDF includes cover page, table of contents, all documents.
Mobile camera upload	Photograph paper documents — OCR converts to searchable text.	SHOULD	Mobile browser camera access. OCR text extracted. User can review before saving.

8. AI Advisor — Quality Standards & UX

The Highest-Stakes Feature

The AI Advisor is RUCompliant's most powerful differentiator and its most significant liability. A compliance tool that gives wrong advice doesn't just fail its users — it actively harms them. Every design decision about the Advisor must prioritise trust, accuracy, and clear escalation above all else.

8.1 Response Structure — HR & Legal Scenarios

Response Element	Required?	Description	Non-Technical User Consideration
Short answer	Always	Headline answer in one sentence.	First sentence must be understandable by Persona 1 without reading further. No jargon.
Creative / negotiated options	Always	What arrangements might work for both parties? Surfaces all viable options.	Frame as: "Here are some ways this could work for everyone..."
Legal entitlements	Always	What can each party legally insist on?	Frame as: "The law says..." not "Under Section 47 of..."
Risk gradient	Always	Where is the legal exposure?	Use plain language: "The main risk here is..." not "Tribunal risk is elevated due to..."
Recommended next step	Always	What should the employer actually do right now?	One specific, actionable step. Not a list of options.
Professional escalation	Where relevant	Explicit flag when the situation warrants professional input.	Warm, not defensive: "This is more complex than I can reliably help with — here is what to do next."

8.2 Confidence Indicator — Detailed Specification

Every AI Advisor response must include a confidence indicator. This is not optional. It is the primary mechanism for managing liability and building trust with non-technical users.

Indicator	Dot Colour	Label	Additional UI	When Used
High confidence	●	"High confidence"	No additional text needed.	Clear regulatory requirements with no ambiguity (e.g. ICO registration threshold, VAT registration threshold).
Moderate confidence	●	"Worth checking"	Text appended: "You may want to confirm this with"	Requirements with context-dependent

Indicator	Dot Colour	Label	Additional UI	When Used
			your accountant or a professional before acting."	nuance (e.g. employment contract terms, GDPR lawful basis).
Low confidence / complex	●	"Get professional advice"	Text appended: "This situation is complex. I'd recommend speaking to a professional before taking any action." + CTA to find a solicitor.	Tribunal risk, dismissal, TUPE, data breaches with ICO notification implications, HMRC investigations.

When the Advisor Must Say 'Get a Solicitor'

Any dismissal of an employee with a protected characteristic (age, disability, pregnancy, race, religion, sex, sexual orientation).

Any potential automatic unfair dismissal scenario (whistleblowing, pregnancy, union activity).

Complex TUPE situations (business acquisitions, outsourcing).

Any data breach involving special category data where ICO notification may be required within 72 hours.

Serious HMRC investigations or compliance disputes.

The escalation trigger should feel helpful, not defensive: 'This situation has some complexity that I want to make sure you handle correctly. I'd recommend speaking to an employment solicitor before taking action.'

8.3 AI Guardrail UX for Non-Technical Users

When a non-technical user sees a Red confidence indicator, they may not know what 'professional advice' means or how to access it. The Advisor must help them take the next step, not just tell them to find a professional.

Situation	What the Advisor Does	MVP vs Future
Red confidence response	Appends: "I'd recommend speaking to an employment solicitor or HR consultant. You can find qualified solicitors at lawsociety.org.uk/find-a-solicitor (opens in new tab)."	MVP
User asks a question the Advisor cannot answer	Advisor responds: "I'm not confident I can give you a reliable answer on this. I'd rather be honest than give you guidance that might be wrong. Here's what I suggest..."	MVP
User seems distressed or in an urgent situation	Advisor surface direct support links before attempting to answer: "It sounds like this is urgent. Before I give you some guidance, here are some direct routes to help..."	MVP
User asks same question three times (possible confusion)	Advisor offers: "Would it help to speak with someone directly? I can show you how to contact support, or find a local advisor."	COULD

9. Accessibility & Plain English Standards

These are not aspirational guidelines. They are acceptance criteria. Features that do not meet these standards should not be merged to main or shipped to users.

9.1 Accessibility Requirements

Standard: WCAG 2.1 Level AA

All RUCompliant interfaces must meet WCAG 2.1 Level AA compliance. This is the legal standard in the UK under the Equality Act 2010 and is the right baseline for a product targeting users of all ages, abilities, and technical backgrounds.

Requirement	Standard	How to Test	Priority
Colour contrast — text	Minimum 4.5:1 ratio for normal text; 3:1 for large text (18pt+)	WebAIM Contrast Checker. Automated in CI via axe-core.	MUST
Colour contrast — UI components	Minimum 3:1 ratio for interactive elements (buttons, form fields, RAG indicators)	Manual check + axe-core.	MUST
RAG indicators must not rely on colour alone	Every Green / Amber / Red status must include a text label or icon in addition to the colour	Remove CSS colour. Can the user still understand the status?	MUST
Keyboard navigation	All interactive elements reachable and operable via keyboard alone. Focus order is logical.	Tab through every screen without a mouse. Focus ring must be visible.	MUST
Screen reader support	All images have alt text. Form fields have labels. Errors are announced to assistive technology.	Test with VoiceOver (Mac/iOS) and NVDA (Windows).	MUST
Touch targets	Minimum 44x44px on mobile. No interactive elements closer than 8px to each other.	Visual inspection on mobile device.	MUST
Text resize	UI remains functional and readable when text is resized to 200% in browser settings.	Set browser text to 200%. Check for overflow, clipping, overlapping elements.	SHOULD
Reduced motion	Animations respect prefers-reduced-motion media query.	Enable OS reduce motion setting. Check all animated elements.	SHOULD

Requirement	Standard	How to Test	Priority
	Critical animations (e.g. Advisor slide-in) have non-animated alternatives.		

9.2 Plain English Standards

'Plain English' is not a vague aspiration. It is a measurable, enforceable standard. Every piece of copy in RUCompliant — UI labels, notification text, Advisor responses, error messages, help documentation — must meet these criteria.

Standard	Target	How to Measure
Flesch-Kincaid Reading Ease score	60 or above (equivalent to plain English readable by a general adult audience)	Hemingway App or equivalent tool. Run on all user-facing copy before release.
Average sentence length	≤15 words per sentence	Automated linting in copywriting workflow.
Banned jargon list	See Appendix A — 50 compliance terms that must always be explained or replaced	Copy review checklist before every release.
Error messages	Must state: what happened, why it happened, and what the user should do next. Never "An error occurred."	Manual QA of every error state before release.
Tooltip requirement	Any term from the banned list that must appear in the UI must have an inline tooltip definition.	Design review checklist.

Appendix A Preview — Banned Jargon List (Sample)

The following terms must NEVER appear in the UI without an inline explanation: RTI, PAYE, VAT, NICs, GDPR, ICO, DPA, TUPE, DSE, RIDDOR, NMW, auto-enrolment, confirmation statement, article of association, making tax digital (MTD), register of persons of significant control (PSC).

Instead use plain alternatives: 'Real-time payroll reporting (RTI)' or link to a tooltip. 'The Information Commissioner's Office (ICO)' on first use, then ICO thereafter.

The full 50-term list is maintained in the RUCompliant Content Style Guide (separate document).

10. Error States & Failure Scenarios

For a compliance product, the error experience is as important as the happy path. A user who encounters a confusing error message during a high-stakes task (e.g. filing a reminder for their VAT return) may lose trust in the entire product. Every error state must be designed, tested, and written before a feature ships.

Scenario	What the User Sees	What the System Does	Recovery Path
AI Advisor is unavailable (API down)	"The Advisor is taking a moment to respond. Try again in a minute, or check our Help Centre for the answer you need." — with a Help Centre link.	Logs error. Alerts engineering via Slack. Does not show a technical error code.	User can access Help Centre. Advisor retries automatically when API recovers.
Regulatory knowledge base is stale (>7 days since last update)	A small banner appears above Advisor responses: "Our regulatory information is being updated. Answers may not reflect the very latest changes. Check gov.uk for anything time-sensitive."	Logs staleness alert. Triggers manual review queue.	Banner removed when knowledge base is updated.
Stripe payment fails	"We couldn't process your payment. Your access continues for 7 days — please update your payment method to avoid interruption." — with a "Update payment" CTA.	Sends email immediately. Retries payment at 3 days and 7 days. Does not immediately suspend access.	User updates payment method via Stripe Customer Portal. Access restored immediately.
Document upload fails (file too large / wrong format)	"This file couldn't be uploaded. Files must be PDF, JPG, or PNG and under 25MB. Try again or contact support if the problem continues."	Logs error with file metadata (not content). Does not partially save.	User can retry with a different file or contact support.
OCR fails on uploaded document	"We couldn't read the text in this document automatically. You can still save it — just add a note about what it contains so you can find it later."	Saves document without extracted text. Flags for manual categorisation.	User manually categorises. Document is still stored and accessible.
Headcount trigger fires but task already exists	No visible error — duplicate check runs silently. User sees no change.	System checks for existing task before inserting. Suppresses duplicate if found within 24 hours.	No user action needed.
User tries to access a feature that requires payment (trial expired)	"Your free trial has ended. Choose a plan to continue — your data is safe and waiting for you." — with pricing	Trial expiry date checked on login. Access suspended for non-billing	User chooses plan. Access restored immediately. No data lost.

Scenario	What the User Sees	What the System Does	Recovery Path
	options and a "Start your plan" CTA.	features. Data is never deleted.	
Internet connection lost mid-task	"It looks like you've gone offline. Don't worry — your progress has been saved. We'll sync everything when you're back online."	Optimistic UI caches last action locally. Syncs when connection restored.	Automatic. No user action needed in most cases.

11. Help & Support Pathway

A non-technical user who is confused needs a clear, fast route to help. The absence of a defined support pathway is one of the most common reasons small business SaaS products fail with non-technical audiences. This section defines how RUCompliant handles users who are stuck.

Design Principle — Help Is Always One Tap Away

A 'Help' link must be visible on every screen at all times. It should never require more than 2 taps to reach a human (or human equivalent). On mobile, it should be in the bottom navigation or persistently visible.

11.1 Self-Service Help (MVP)

Component	Description	MoSCoW
In-app Help panel	Accessible from sidebar nav "Help" item. Slides in from the right (same pattern as AI Advisor). Contains: search bar, 5–10 most-viewed articles, and articles relevant to the current page.	MUST
Contextual Help links	Each module has a "?" icon in the top-right corner that opens the Help panel pre-filtered to articles relevant to that module.	MUST
Tooltip system	Any jargon term in the UI has an underline + tooltip on hover/tap. Tooltip content is maintained in a separate content document.	MUST
AI Advisor as first-line support	The AI Advisor handles the majority of 'how do I...' questions. Before contacting support, the user is nudged to ask the Advisor.	MUST
Help Centre (external — Notion or similar)	A searchable collection of plain-English articles. Minimum 20 articles at MVP covering the most common questions from persona research.	SHOULD
Video walkthroughs	Short (90-second) screen recordings of key flows: completing Stage 1, uploading a document, asking the Advisor a question.	COULD

11.2 Direct Support (MVP — Email Only)

Channel	Availability	Response Time Target	MoSCoW
Email support	Business hours (Mon–Fri 9am–5pm UK)	24 hours for general queries, 4 hours for billing issues	MUST
In-app "Contact us" form	Always accessible from Help panel. Pre-populates with	24 hours	MUST

Channel	Availability	Response Time Target	MoSCoW
	user account details and current page URL.		
Live chat (Intercom or similar)	Business hours — post-MVP	Under 5 minutes during hours	SHOULD (Phase 3)
Phone support	Not offered — email and chat are sufficient for the target market	N/A	WON'T

Support Quality Principle

Every support interaction is a product research opportunity. All support conversations must be tagged by category (billing, feature confusion, compliance question, bug report) and reviewed weekly. If more than 3 users ask the same question in a week, it is a product gap — not a support issue.

12. Technology Stack

The stack is intentionally lean. Every tool is chosen to do a specific job well. Supabase is the unified backend — it replaces a separate API server, auth service, file storage, and real-time layer.

Layer	Technology	Rationale
Build Tool	Vite	Near-instant dev server HMR. Native ES modules. First-class TypeScript support. Production builds via Rollup.
Frontend Framework	React 18	Concurrent features for smooth Advisor panel animations. Large ecosystem. Maps cleanly to modular architecture.
Styling	Tailwind CSS v3	Utility-first. Sidebar states, RAG colour variants, and responsive breakpoints expressed as class composites. JIT compiler keeps bundle small.
Language	TypeScript	Type safety across Supabase schema, API contracts, and component props. Catches compliance logic errors at compile time.
Backend / BaaS	Supabase	PostgreSQL database, Auth (email + OAuth + magic link), Storage (Document Vault), Realtime subscriptions (Health Score live updates), Edge Functions, Row Level Security.
AI / RAG	Anthropic Claude API + pgvector	Claude for Advisor responses and document analysis. pgvector for semantic search over the regulatory knowledge base. Retrieval logic in Supabase Edge Functions.
Routing	React Router v6	Nested routes for module layouts. URL state for Advisor open/closed persisted in query params.
State Management	Zustand	Lightweight global store for: sidebar state, Advisor panel, Health Score, notification queue. No Redux boilerplate.
Payments	Stripe	Subscriptions, annual billing, usage metering for AI queries. Stripe Customer Portal for self-serve billing management.
Email	Resend	Transactional email for compliance reminders, digest emails, escalation alerts. React Email templates.
SMS	Twilio	Red-tier SMS alerts. SHOULD HAVE — activated in Phase 3.
Hosting	Vercel	Zero-config deployment from GitHub. Edge network CDN. Preview deployments per PR.

13. Pricing

RUCompliant uses a single, transparent price. One plan. Everything included. No tier confusion, no feature-gating, no upsells once you are in. The decision the user makes is only about how they want to pay.

RUCompliant — Everything Included

£49.99 per month — cancel anytime — everything included

— or —

£499.99 per year — pay upfront, get 2 months free (equivalent to paying for 10 months)

Save £99.89 by choosing the annual plan.

14-day free trial — no credit card required.

Option	What You Pay	What You Get	Effective Monthly
Monthly	£49.99 on billing date each month. Cancel anytime — no penalty, no notice period.	Rolling access to everything included.	£49.99
Annual (upfront)	£499.99 charged once per year.	12 months full access. 2 months free — pay for 10, get 12.	£41.67 — saving £99.89 vs monthly

Why One Price

A single price removes the trust damage of tiered pricing. The microbusiness owner never wonders whether they are on the right plan or missing features they are paying for. At £49.99/month, one avoided HMRC late filing penalty (£200+) covers four months of subscription.

14. Development Roadmap

Phase	Timeframe	Focus	Key Deliverables (MUST HAVES first)
Phase 1 Validate	Month 1	Market validation + stack setup	Interview 30+ microbusiness owners across all 3 personas. Validate £49.99/month price point. Build Figma prototype of FTUE, Health Score, Concierge Journey, and Advisor flyout. Set up Vite + React + Supabase + Tailwind scaffold. Load first regulatory sources into pgvector.
Phase 2 MVP	Months 2–4	All MUST HAVES	Guided sign-up flow (5 questions). Dashboard as homepage with Health Score. Concierge Journey Stages 1–3. Task Calendar with statutory deadlines. AI Advisor flyout with RAG and chat history. Empty states for all screens. Help pathway (email support + in-app Help panel). Email notifications via Resend. Document Vault (basic upload + categorise). Stripe billing (monthly + annual, 14-day trial, no card at signup). Full accessibility audit (WCAG 2.1 AA). Plain English audit of all copy.
Phase 3 Launch	Months 4–6	SHOULD HAVES + Beta	HR & Employment Hub (pre-hire through contract generator). Headcount trigger logic (automatic task activation). Push + SMS notifications (Twilio). Google Calendar sync. Accountant share link. Regulatory news feed. Monthly digest emails. Beta with 100 microbusinesses. Multi-user access (shared login documented in onboarding).
Phase 4 Scale	Months 7–12	COULD HAVES + Retention	Full H&S module with headcount-aware obligation map. GDPR Tiers 2 + 3. Evidence pack export. Gamification (streak, badges). AI Advisor voice input. Compliance Health Score website widget. White-label option for accountants. Post-MVP: native mobile app evaluation.

14.1 MVP Success Metrics

Metric	Target (End of Month 6)	Measurement Method
Paying customers	200+ active subscriptions	Stripe MRR dashboard
Annual plan take-up	30%+ of new signups choose annual	Stripe subscription metadata
FTUE completion rate	70%+ of new users complete all 5 sign-up questions and reach the dashboard	In-app event tracking (Supabase analytics)
Concierge completion rate	60%+ of new users complete Stage 1	In-app event tracking
Dashboard weekly engagement	60%+ of active users visit dashboard at least once per week	Supabase analytics

Metric	Target (End of Month 6)	Measurement Method
Task calendar engagement	70%+ of users open at least 1 calendar reminder per month	Email open rates + in-app events
Advisor usage	50%+ of users use Advisor at least once per month	advisor_conversations table query count
Health Score Red events actioned	80%+ of Red alerts resolved within 7 days	compliance_tasks status tracking
Month 3 retention	75%+ of Month 1 subscribers still active	Stripe churn tracking
Support ticket volume	<5% of monthly active users contact support per month (indicates self-service is working)	Support inbox tagging
Accessibility compliance	0 critical WCAG 2.1 AA violations in automated testing	axe-core CI integration
NPS	50+	In-app survey at 30 days post-signup

15. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
AI Advisor gives legally incorrect advice	Medium	High	Confidence scoring on every response. Clear "guidance not legal advice" framing. Professional escalation triggers for high-risk scenarios. Expert advisory board review quarterly. RAG grounding reduces hallucination risk significantly.
Regulatory changes invalidate calendar deadlines	High	High	GOV.UK Content API daily monitoring. Any threshold or deadline change triggers immediate audit of affected compliance_tasks across all accounts. Human editorial review before changes pushed live.
Non-technical users abandon FTUE before completion	High	High	FTUE designed specifically for Persona 1 (Sarah). ≤5 questions. Mobile-first. Magic link removes password barrier. If user abandons, email re-engagement sequence starts at 24 hours. Progress always saved — user can resume exactly where they left off.
Empty state experience fails to engage new users	Medium	High	Dashboard never truly empty after sign-up — auto-populated deadlines and Concierge Journey Stage 1 tasks ensure there is always something to do. User testing with Persona 1 before launch.
Accessibility non-compliance creates legal exposure	Medium	High	WCAG 2.1 AA is a hard acceptance criterion. axe-core runs in CI. Manual accessibility audit before MVP launch. Screen reader testing on VoiceOver and NVDA.
Low annual plan conversion	Medium	Medium	"2 months free" is a concrete, tangible offer — not a percentage discount. Shown prominently at signup and on pricing page. In-app prompt at Day 45 of monthly plan offering the switch.
User abandonment after Concierge Journey completion	High	Medium	Task Calendar creates ongoing reason to return. Monthly digest email. Health Score widget on their website creates daily visibility. Gamification and streak mechanics (Phase 4).
Multi-user confusion (couples, partners)	Medium	Medium	Single shared login documented clearly in onboarding. Tooltip in account settings: "More than one person manages your business? You can share your login for now — multi-user access is coming soon." Full multi-user in Phase 3.
Accountants seen as competition	Low	Medium	Position RUCompliant as handling routine reminders so accountants focus on high-value work. Accountant share feature makes RUCompliant a collaboration tool. White-label option converts them to resellers.

Appendix A — Jargon Banned List & Plain English Alternatives

Any of the following terms appearing in the UI must include an inline tooltip definition or be replaced with the plain English alternative. This list is maintained in the RUCompliant Content Style Guide and reviewed quarterly.

Jargon Term	Plain English Alternative / Required Tooltip
RTI (Real Time Information)	"Real-time payroll reporting (RTI)" — or tooltip: "The system HMRC uses to receive payroll information each time you pay an employee."
PAYE	"Pay As You Earn (PAYE)" — tooltip: "The system HMRC uses to collect Income Tax and National Insurance from employees."
NICs / National Insurance Contributions	"National Insurance" — always spell out on first use
GDPR	"UK data protection law (GDPR)" on first use — tooltip with plain-English summary available.
ICO	"The Information Commissioner's Office (ICO)" on first use — then ICO thereafter with tooltip.
DPA 2018	"The Data Protection Act 2018" — link to plain-English guide
TUPE	Always use full form: "Transfer of Undertakings (Protection of Employment) — TUPE". Always recommend solicitor.
DSE Assessment	"Display Screen Equipment (DSE) assessment" — tooltip: "A check to ensure your computer workstation is set up safely for anyone who uses it for a significant part of their working day."
RIDDOR	"Workplace accident reporting (RIDDOR)" — tooltip: "The law that requires employers to report certain workplace accidents, injuries, and dangerous occurrences to the Health and Safety Executive."
NMW / National Minimum Wage	Always spell out: "National Minimum Wage (NMW)" on first use. Include current rate in tooltip.
Auto-enrolment	"Workplace pension (auto-enrolment)" — tooltip: "If you employ eligible staff, you're legally required to automatically enrol them in a workplace pension scheme and contribute to it."
Confirmation Statement	"Annual Companies House update (Confirmation Statement)" — tooltip: "A yearly filing to Companies House confirming your company's basic information is up to date."
Making Tax Digital (MTD)	"Digital tax record-keeping (Making Tax Digital)" — tooltip: "HMRC's requirement that VAT-registered businesses keep digital records and submit VAT returns using approved software."
PSC Register	"Register of company owners (PSC Register)" — tooltip: "A legal requirement for limited companies to record details of anyone who owns more than 25% of shares or voting rights."
Articles of Association	"Company rules document (Articles of Association)" — tooltip: "A legal document that sets out the rules for running your limited company."

Jargon Term	Plain English Alternative / Required Tooltip
DPIA	"Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA)" — tooltip: "A process to identify and reduce the privacy risks of a new project or system that involves personal data."
DPO	"Data Protection Officer (DPO)" — tooltip: "A person responsible for overseeing data protection strategy. Only certain organisations are legally required to appoint one."
Lawful basis (GDPR)	Always explain inline: "Your legal reason for collecting and using personal data."
Special category data	"Sensitive personal data" — tooltip: "Personal information that deserves extra protection under data protection law, such as health, race, religion, or political opinions."
P60 / P45 / P11D	Always use full form with tooltip explaining what the document is and when it must be issued.